

Recommend an App or Tool, and Say When the Other One Is Better

Recommend

OREO

Option Challenge

Name: _____ Date: _____

SLIDE 02 Today's goal

By the end of this lesson, I can:

Find out what a team needs, recommend one of two apps or tools with a reason and a comparison, and say when the other one is the better choice.

- WHO** You and Mei Ling (accounts) are looking at how the team hands in expense claims. Claims go in by the 25th and are paid once a month.
- SITUATION** Today everyone hands in a paper form with the receipts. Every month two or three receipts go missing. There are two ways to change it: see the two boxes below.
- NEED** Mr. Tan wants a recommendation on Friday. 8 people make claims. The needs: no more lost receipts, not more than RM150 a month, and it must work for the 3 sales staff who are out most days.
- GOAL** Recommend one tool, say why it fits the needs, say when the other one is better, and answer Mr. Tan's questions.

Claims app

- RM15 a user a month · 8 users = RM120
- Take a photo of the receipt on your phone
- One-hour training for everyone

Shared spreadsheet

- Free · everyone already knows how to use it
- Type your claim at your computer in the office
- Paper receipts still go in an envelope to Mei Ling

SLIDE 03 Try it first

Mr. Tan asks: "So, the claims app or the shared spreadsheet? Which one should we use?" Say something for 30 seconds. Then note what you said.

SLIDE 04 A good message

Mei Ling's answer. Mark where each part starts.

We need to stop losing receipts, so I'd recommend the claims app. The main reason is the photo. With the app, Kumar takes a photo of the receipt at the petrol station, so it can't get lost, even when he's out all day. The spreadsheet is cheaper because it's free, but we still hand in paper receipts. The app is RM120 a month for the eight of us, and that's under RM150. So the app is the better choice for us. But if a team works in the office all day, the spreadsheet is better: it's free, and nobody needs training.

O

NEED · RECOMMEND

R

REASON

E

COMPARE · EXAMPLE

O

RECOMMEND AGAIN · IF

SLIDE 05 Organise it

Ali recommends a way to keep track of the office laptops. Order: Recommend → Reason → Compare → Recommend again + if.

- ☐ So the book is enough for us. But if we have more than ten laptops, the app is better.
- ☐ The main reason is that it's easy: you write your name and the date, and Siti can check it.
- ☐ People often can't find the spare laptop, so I'd recommend a sign-out book at reception.
- ☐ A booking app is faster to search, but it costs RM40 a month, and we only have three laptops and a projector.

Write the letter: **O** = Need · recommend · **R** = Reason · **E** = Compare · example · **O** = Recommend again · if

SLIDE 06 Useful language

Tick the expressions you used today.

ASK ABOUT THE NEED

- ☐ How many people need it?
- ☐ What's the budget?
- ☐ What's the problem now?
- ☐ What's the most important thing?

COMPARE

- ☐ ... is cheaper than ...
- ☐ ... is easier to use, but ...
- ☐ ... costs more, but ...

RECOMMEND

- ☐ We need ..., so I'd recommend ...
- ☐ I think we should use ...
- ☐ It may be better to ...
- ☐ ... is the better choice for us.

SAY WHEN THE OTHER ONE IS BETTER

- ☐ But if you ..., ... is better.
 - ☐ If you only need ..., ... is enough.
 - ☐ ... is better for people who ...
-

SLIDE 07 Connect the ideas

Choose the connector and write the new sentence.

1. The spreadsheet is free. [**because** / **for example**, / **but**] We still hand in paper receipts.

2. Kumar takes a photo of each receipt. [**but** / **if** / **so**] Nothing gets lost.

3. I'd recommend the claims app. [**but** / **because** / **so**] It works on the phone.

4. Everyone works in the office all day. [**For example**, / **If ...** / **because**] The spreadsheet is better.

SLIDE 08 Time control

Circle the right form. Why?

1. The claims app _____ RM15 a user a month. (A fact about a tool now)

☐ to cost

☐ costs

☐ costing
 2. The spreadsheet is _____ than the claims app. (Comparing two tools)

☐ cheaper

☐ cheapest

☐ more cheap
 3. If a team _____ only two claims a month, the spreadsheet is fine. (The if part)

☐ having

☐ has

☐ to have
 4. Everyone in the office _____ how to use a spreadsheet. (A fact about people now)

☐ knowing

☐ know

☐ knows
-

SLIDE 09 Comparing · if ... is better

To recommend a tool, compare the two with -er / more ... than, then say when the other one is better with if + present.

The spreadsheet is **cheaper than** the app, but it's **slower** for the sales team.

The app is **more expensive**, but it's **easier** for people who are out.

If a team **works** in the office all day, the spreadsheet **is better**.

If you only **need** a list, a whiteboard **is enough**.

SLIDE 10 Build your message

Fill each part with your own idea. You will use the same parts in the task.



NEED · RECOMMEND

We need ..., so I'd recommend ...



REASON

The main reason is ...



COMPARE · EXAMPLE

... is cheaper / easier than ..., but ...



RECOMMEND AGAIN · IF

So ... is the better choice for us. But if ..., ... is better.

SLIDE 11 Option Challenge

The recommender asks what the listener needs, recommends one of two tools and says when the other one is better. The listener writes a note: the choice, the need it fits, why not the other one, and when the other one is better.

1. Round 1 (3:00): say your card number and the two tools. Ask about the need, recommend one, say when the other is better.
2. Listener: give the needs when asked, fill the note. Blank line? Ask 'Why not the other?' 'When is the other one better?'
3. Round 2 (2:00): line B moves one seat. Same card, new listener: check the needs ('Six people, right?'), choice, 'if'.
4. Round 3 (1:00), frames closed, no asking: 'You need ..., so ...'. Workbook over, card only. Then swap roles and repeat.

Card 1 · The team's task list

Card 2 · Booking the meeting room

Card 3 · A family's spending

Card 4 · Cake orders at home

Listener's note

	ROUND 1	ROUND 2	ROUND 3
Card · asked first?			
Choice · which need?			
Why not the other one?			
Other one is better if			

My partner's question or concern, and what I answered:

SLIDE 12 Respond

Mr. Tan asks. Write a short answer to one of these.

1. How much does it cost for all eight of us?
2. How long does it take to learn?
3. What does Kumar do with his receipts when he's out?

Start with: **For the eight of us, it's ...** · **It takes ...** / **Nobody needs to learn it, because ...** · **When he's out, he ...**

SLIDE 13 Transfer

The residents' association in your taman collects RM20 a month from each of 60 houses for the guard. An e-wallet QR code: free, the money comes in at once, but some older neighbours don't use e-wallets. A volunteer going door to door: free, anyone can pay cash, but it takes two evenings a month. Recommend one, and say when the other one is better.

They need ..., so I'd recommend ... · **The main reason is ...** · **... is easier / faster than ..., but ...** · **But if ..., ... is better.**

SLIDE 14 Did I do it?

Be honest. Tick what you did in the task.

☐

Names the need and recommends one tool.

☐

Compares the two tools on a need and gives a reason.

☐

Says when the other tool is the better choice.

SLIDE 15 Feedback: how can I improve?

Circle one number for each area. 1 = I need help · 2 = OK · 3 = Good

Need and recommendation

☐ 1

☐ 2

☐ 3

Comparing on a need

☐ 1

☐ 2

☐ 3

When the other one is better

☐ 1

☐ 2

☐ 3

Useful expressions

☐ 1

☐ 2

☐ 3

Confidence

☐ 1

☐ 2

☐ 3

My improvement action: Next time, I will _____.

WE BELIEVE IN THE POWER OF PRACTICAL SPEAKING TO INSPIRE CONFIDENCE

After class: open the After class review

SLIDE 11 **Listener cards: fold or cut**

Only the listener looks at a card. It says what to find out and write in the note.

Card 1 • The team's task list

You are Siti. When asked, tell them: 6 people in the team, 2 visit customers most days, and about RM50 a month at most. Fill the note. No 'if'? Ask: 'When is the other one better?'

Card 2 • Booking the meeting room

You are Kumar. When asked, say: 12 staff share one room, no money for it, two groups often book the same time, and three counter staff have no computer. No 'if'? Ask: 'When is the other one better?'

Card 3 • A family's spending

You are Mei Ling. When asked, say: you want to see where your money goes, RM10 a month is fine, you pay by e-wallet, your mother pays cash. Fill the note. No 'if'? Ask: 'When is the other one better?'

Card 4 • Cake orders at home

You are Ali. When asked, say: your wife sells cakes: 40 orders a week before a festival, 3 at other times. She's too busy to reply. RM50 a month is fine. No 'if'? Ask: 'When is the other one better?'

SLIDE 11 **Speaker cards: fold or cut**

Only the speaker looks at a card. The listener keeps this page folded.

Card 1 · The team's task list

Task board app: RM10 a user a month, works on the phone, sends reminders, takes a morning to set up. Whiteboard in the office: free, already there, everyone sees it at the 9 a.m. meeting.

Card 2 · Booking the meeting room

Online calendar: free, book on your computer, shows who booked the room, everyone must log in. Paper sheet on the meeting room door: free, very easy, anyone can write on it, but you must walk to the door to see it.

Card 3 · A family's spending

Budget app: RM9 a month, links to your e-wallet and bank card, shows a chart of your spending. Notebook: RM3 once, you write every item by hand, anyone can use it, no chart.

Card 4 · Cake orders at home

Order app: RM30 a month, customers order and pay online, it lists the orders by pick-up day. Chat group and a notebook: free, but you reply to every message and write every order yourself.